

To Whom it May Concern,

I believe that the determination that no responsive records exist is incorrect.

The Federal Reserve has, in the past, had geographic identifiers from the 1977 SCF and made them available to researchers. Below, images "Chatterji Seamans (2012)" and "Zinman (2002)" contain excerpts from two academic papers which have used state of residence data from the 1977 SCF. I have spoken with authors of both papers, who confirm that state of residence of 1977 SCF respondents was available to them at the time they wrote those papers, but they no longer have retained the data.

At the very least, I believe that records must exist which can identify the Principal Survey Unit (PSU) that administered each individual survey in the 1977 SCF, which would be sufficient to satisfy my request. The Principal Survey Units are publicly available in all SCFs prior to 1977, including 1971. Below image "PSUs from 1971 SCF" shows the description of the PSUs in the 1971 SCF. I believe that the Federal Reserve's internal records from the administration of the 1977 SCF would contain this information. Below image "Sample Address Summary from 1977 SCF", which is a screenshot from the 1977 SCF codebook, shows that this information was collected in the 1977 SCF – in this sample address summary, the PSU is shown as "Pulaski". Records for the PSU (e.g. "Pulaski") of respondents from the 1977 SCF would be sufficient to satisfy my request.

Kindly,
Joseph

Abstract of “Chatterji & Seamans (2012)”

Entrepreneurial finance, credit cards, and race[☆]

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ABSTRACT

This paper examines the impact of financial deregulation on entrepreneurship. We assess the impact of credit card deregulation on transitions into self-employment using state-level removal of credit card interest rate ceilings following the US Supreme Court's 1978 *Marquette* decision as a quasi-natural experiment. We find that credit card deregulation increases the probability of entrepreneurial entry, with a particularly strong effect for black entrepreneurs. We demonstrate that these effects are magnified in states with a history of racial discrimination and link the results to discrimination-based barriers to entry.

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Table 9 of “Chatterji & Seamans (2012)”

Table 9

Effect of state-level credit card interest rate ceilings on entrepreneurship levels, using Survey of Consumer Finance (SCF) data.

This table reports the linear probability of self-employment levels on state-level credit card interest rate ceilings, black, and their interaction, using data from SCF for 1977, 1983, and 1986. The sample is split by credit card ownership in columns 2–3. Credit card interest rate ceilings for states with no limit are set equal to the highest rate ceiling across states in that year. This implies the rate ceiling varies from 24 for no-limit states prior to 1981 and 25 for no-limit states in 1981 and after. Individual characteristics include female, age, age squared, high school graduate, married, homeowner, household income, urban area indicator, local unemployment rate, and percent of local population living in rural areas. Fixed effects for years and 36 states are included (the SCF excludes DC, HI, ID, KS, MD, MT, ND, NH, NM, NV, RI, VT, WV, and WY). Robust standard errors are included in brackets and clustered at the state level. *Significant at 10%; **Significant at 5%; ***Significant at 1%.

	(1)	Owns credit card?	
		No (2)	Yes (3)
Rate	–0.2146 [0.2478]	0.007 [0.4017]	–0.2339 [0.3071]
Black	–0.1462*** [0.0291]	–0.0983 [0.0592]	–0.1347*** [0.0345]
Black*rate	0.6147*** [0.1323]	0.3055 [0.3015]	0.5830*** [0.1501]
Individual characteristics	Y	Y	Y
Year fixed effects	Y	Y	Y
State fixed effects	Y	Y	Y
Number of observations	4889	1203	3686
R-squared	0.029	0.049	0.034

Abstract of “Zinman (2002)”:

The Impact of Liquidity on Household Balance Sheets:
Micro Responses to a Credit Card Supply Shock

Jonathan Zinman*
Federal Reserve Bank of New York
January 10, 2003

ABSTRACT

Despite growing evidence that many US households are liquidity constrained, there remains little consensus on the quantitative importance or nature of these constraints. This paper develops a new type of evidence on the impacts of consumer credit markets on behavior by examining household-level responses to an exogenous liquidity shock. A United States Supreme Court decision effectively deregulated bank credit card interest rates in December 1978, and I find that consumers from states with binding usury ceilings before the decision became more likely to hold bank cards after the decision, relative to their counterparts in unaffected states. The marginal cardholders appear to have characteristics widely associated with credit constraints, and to borrow frequently on their new cards. Yet there is little evidence that these cardholders exploit their newfound liquidity by shifting into higher-yielding, less liquid, or riskier assets. This finding is at odds with standard models of liquidity constraints, and motivates consideration of alternative explanations for the widely observed sensitivity of consumers to liquidity.

Excerpt of “Zinman (2002)”

B. Bankcard Usury Laws

I determined whether each state that appears in the SCF had a binding bankcard usury law as of the 1977 survey date (July 1977) by referring to the appropriate superceded state statutes. I then confirmed that my reading of the statutes was correct (e.g., that there were no legal loopholes or enforcement practices that might effectively raise *de jure* low ceilings, or lower *de jure* high ceilings), by consulting secondary sources (including Gushee, various years; American Bankers' Association, various years; and dozens of law review articles). Oregon's bankcard usury law was both unique in construction and in a state of flux in 1976-77, so I drop the 47 Oregon households in the 1977 SCF from my estimation sample.

PSUs from 1971 SCF

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Standard PSU Code (Arranged in numerical order. See below for details of this code.)

001-002 Los Angeles City	385-386 Jefferson, Ky.
003-004 Los Angeles suburbs	395-396 Dade, Fla.
011-012 San Francisco & Oakland Cities	405-406 Tulsa, Okla.
013-014 San Francisco suburbs	415-416 Richmond, Va.
101-102 Chicago City, north	425-426 Pulaski, Ark.
103-104 Chicago suburbs	435-436 Taylor, Tex.
111-112 Chicago City, south	445-446 Montgomery, Ala.
121-122 Cleveland City	455-456 Richland, S. Car.
123-124 Cleveland Suburbs	465-466 Orange, Fla.
131-132 Detroit City	475-476 Fayette, Ky.
133-134 Detroit suburbs	487-488 Sarasota, Fla.
141-142 St. Louis City	497-498 Pitt, N. Car.
143-144 St. Louis suburbs	507-508 Pulaski, Va.
201-202 New York City (Bronx & Queens)	517-518 Mississippi, Ark.
211-212 New York City (Brooklyn)	527-528 Erath, Tex.
221-222 New York City (Manhattan)	537-538 Clark, Ark.
231-232 New York (Richmond)	547-548 East Carroll, La.
233-234 New York suburbs (in New York State)	557-558 Rankin, Miss.
241-242 Jersey City and Newark, N.J.	567-568 Muhlenberg, Ky.
243-244 New York suburbs (in New Jersey)	577-578 Hickman, Tenn.
271-272 Boston City	587-588 Watauga, N. Car.
273-274 Boston suburbs	597-598 Currituck, N. Car.
281-282 Philadelphia City	607-608 Franklin, Neb.
283-284 Philadelphia suburbs	617-618 Stoddard, Mo.
291-292 Pittsburgh City	627-628 Crawford, Iowa
293-294 Pittsburgh suburbs	637-638 Marshall, Ind.
301-302 Baltimore City	647-648 St. Joseph, Mich.
303-304 Baltimore suburbs	657-658 Adair, Mo.
311-312 Washington City	667-668 Logan, Ill.
313-314 Washington suburbs	677-678 Knox, Ohio
365-366 Harris, Tex.	687-688 Hancock, Ohio
375-376 Atlanta, Ga.	697-698 Sheboygan, Wisc.

Sample Address Summary with PSU from 1977 SCF

PSU <i>Pulaski</i> PROJ. <i>466220</i> PLACE <i>Dublin</i>		SAMPLE ADDRESS SUMMARY						
ADDRESS	INTERVIEWER ASSIGNED	RESULT ON CALLS					DATE MAILED	COMMENTS
		1ST	2ND	3RD	4TH	ADD		
L	0007							
1 240 Urban St.	B							This is an example of a "take all" segment. After listing a segment, the interviewer makes out a blue cover sheet for each line in the sample.
L								
2 270 Urban St.								
L								
3 114 S. Henry right side, 2nd Fl. Apt.								
L								
4 114 S. Henry left side, 2nd Fl. Apt.								
L								
5 HU just north of 200 Main, Single story frame w/ shed roof on stone foundation								
L								
6 Apt. over large garage Behind 270 Urban St. Entrance on West Side								NOTE: Since this HU was discovered during interviewing and was not covered by an existing line, it was added at the bottom of the segment listing sheet, on the next available line, in this case line 6. Had the Sample Address Summary and blue folder been sent in before this HU was discovered, the interviewer would write the address, the line number, and the segment number on an Immediate Action form and send it to the Field Office. NEVER RELIST!!!